NetEase Cloud Music

User research → scoped product requirements | Aug–Nov 2026

A mobile-product study covering catalog organization, listening interruptions, report handling and informed choice for AI-generated music, with user flows, business rules and acceptance criteria.

159 responses collected | 110 retained responses | 30 public feedback items | 12 requirement groups

My work

Survey and feedback analysis, prioritization, competitive comparison, three mobile-experience proposals and an AI-music transparency PRD.

Delivery status

Research and requirements are complete. Screens are conceptual wireframes. Current-version checks, technical review, usability validation and rollout remain future work; metrics describe a validation plan.

Sample boundaries

19 survey questions. Ages 18–30: 101 (91.8%); students: 83 (75.5%); men: 79. Recruitment used personal networks and forwarding. Findings describe this sample.

How evidence is used

Survey results estimate reach and segment differences. Thirty public feedback items provide task-level context. Associations inform hypotheses with explicit limits on causal interpretation.

Separate friction from behavioral consequences

Findings from the 110 retained responses

Evidence	Sample finding	Product implication
Search usage	109 of 110 respondents	Protect the path from discovery to playback
Promotion friction	51 (46.4%); 2.50 / 5 rating	Unify timing, frequency, dismissal and task recovery
Navigation friction	37 (33.6%); usability 2.95 / 5	Prioritize stable core entry points and configurable modules
Catalog problems	25; 23 reported behavior/payment changes	Distinguish licensing dependencies from interface scope
Lapsed membership	30 of 32 used competing apps	Evaluate renewal value as a separate segment
Repeated recommendations	24 of 64 recommendation users	Preserve matching strengths; improve exploration and control

Analysis method

3,000 permutation tests for associations; Cramer's V for categorical relationships and epsilon-squared for score/intention differences. Benjamini–Hochberg FDR correction covered 34 tests.

Interpretation limits

Advertising was frequent and poorly rated, but its association with reported behavioral change did not remain significant after FDR adjustment. Repetition complaints came from active recommendation users; exposure affects the pattern.

Preserve existing strengths

Positive feedback highlighted preference matching, synchronized lyrics, stable playback, and comment stories. Proposed improvements target specific gaps within user tasks.

From 12 requirement groups to three proposals

Keep the original scoring record and final PRD scope distinct

Final proposal	Requirement lineage	Scope decision
Complete artist catalog browsing	R07	P1; accessible entries, filters, sort order and explicit batch scope
Promotion control and module management	R02 / R03	P1; current-version and membership checks precede development
Report progress and interaction safety	R09 / R10	P0; prioritize a traceable safety and trust workflow

Prioritization framework

Reach, task impact, behavioral impact and evidence strength each receive 1–3 points. Core-task blockers and safety issues qualify for P0. R01 has A/B subrequirements: 12 groups and 13 scored entries.

Scope revision

Early drafts explored licensing explanations, cloud-library batch tools and cross-device synchronization. Rechecking existing capabilities and concrete feedback removed complex mechanisms with weak evidence or heavy dependencies from the final scope. Original scores remain decision history.

Competitive lenses

QQ Music is the domestic direct competitor for retrieval, content and memberships. Spotify is the product-model reference for library organization, recommendation control and cross-device tasks. Observations retain the August 20, 2026 research cutoff.

Turn comparisons into decisions

Evaluate whether users can identify operation scope, resume listening, and track report handling. List licensing supply, synchronization and commercial revenue as dependencies with validation gates.

Find the catalog. Confirm the operation scope.

P1 | Complete artist catalog browsing and organization

Main path

Artist page → all songs/albums → filter by type and release date → play current results or add them to a playlist → review outcome details.

Business rules

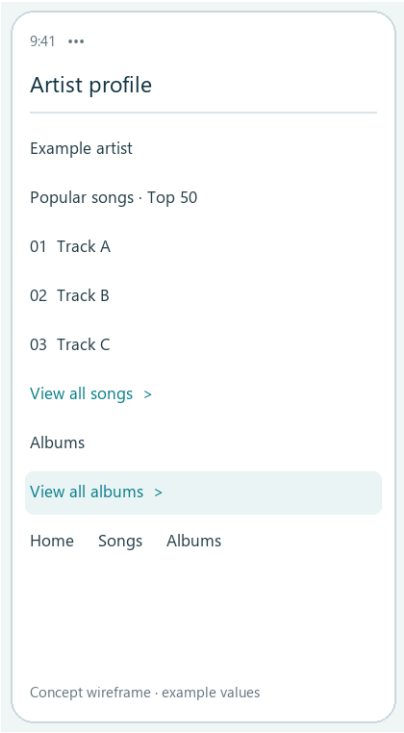
Label the popular section “Top 50” and expose the complete catalog. Unknown metadata goes to “Other.” Deduplicate batch additions and report added, existing, unavailable and failed items separately.

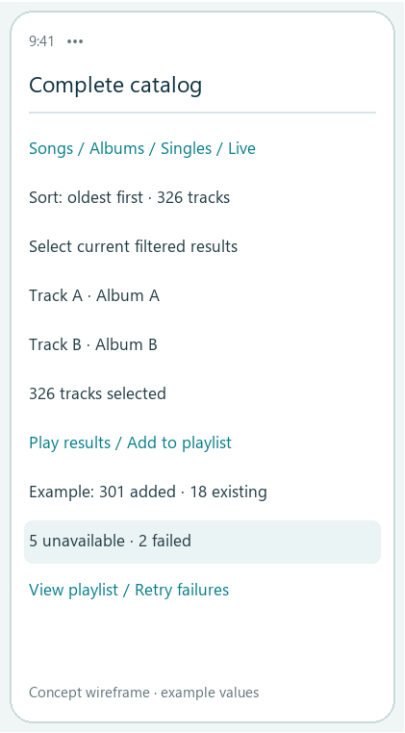
Recovery behavior

Pagination and background tasks keep large catalogs usable. Preserve filters and scroll position when returning. Retry failed items only, using idempotency to avoid duplicate successful writes.

Acceptance and measures

Check entry visibility, filtering, playback scope and batch outcomes. Track full-catalog entry reach, task completion, batch success and failed-item recovery.





Dismiss the promotion. Resume the task.

P1 | Current-release checks are a prerequisite

Display decision

Check task context, playback, session/day limits, recent dismissal, membership entitlement and creative validity. Defer ordinary promotions or use a non-blocking area when interruption is inappropriate.

Dismissal and frequency

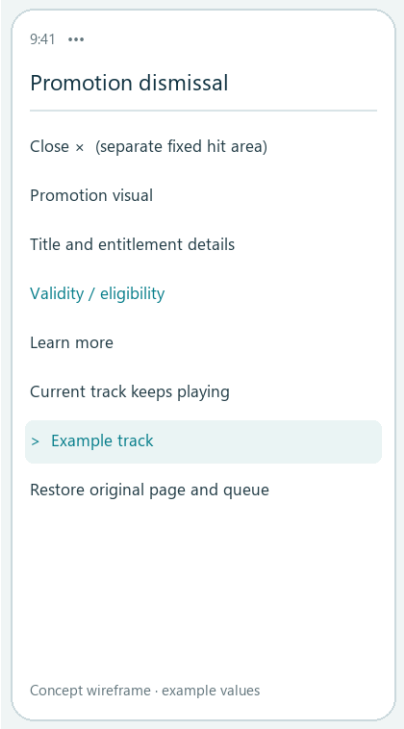
After dismissal, the same promotion stays suppressed for the session. A session ends after more than 30 minutes in the background. Separate dismissal from navigation; the PRD specifies a fixed hit area of at least 44 × 44 pt.

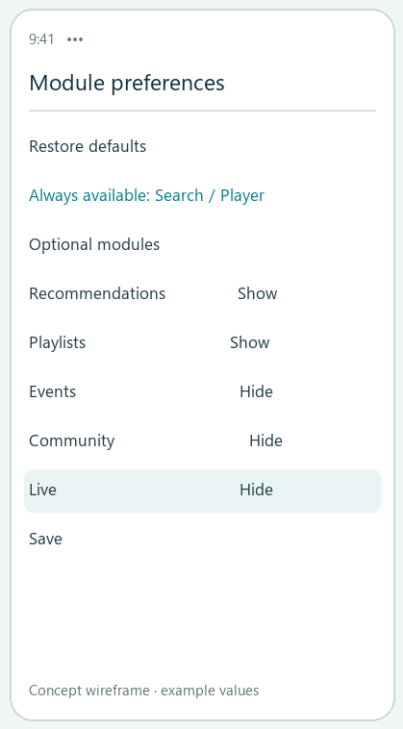
Modules and entitlements

Keep search, playback, safety and account entries accessible. Optional modules can be hidden, reordered and reset. Entitlement failures use a low-interruption fallback; safety notices use separate rules.

Validation and measures

Retest signed-out, free, VIP and SVIP accounts across launch/return/track-change scenarios and network conditions. Compare repeat exposure, task recovery, accidental navigation and commercial conversion together.


9:41 •••
Promotion dismissal
Close × (separate fixed hit area)
Promotion visual
Title and entitlement details
Validity / eligibility
Learn more
Current track keeps playing
> Example track
Restore original page and queue
Concept wireframe · example values


9:41 •••
Module preferences
Restore defaults
Always available: Search / Player
Optional modules
Recommendations Show
Playlists Show
Events Hide
Community Hide
Live Hide
Save
Concept wireframe · example values

Make report handling visible and traceable.

P0 | Comment and stranger-interaction safety

Routing and state

Violations go to reporting; unrelated content goes to quality feedback; personal dislikes go to preference controls. Show “Accepted” only after the server returns a case ID, followed by review, additional-information requests and an outcome.

Immediate protection

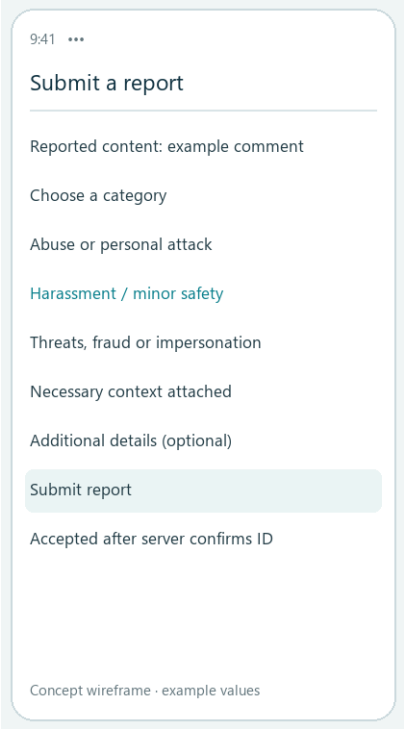
Exit and local blocking take effect first. During network failure, isolate locally and sync later. Blocking is personal contact control. Moderation uses evidence and rules; report volume supports triage.

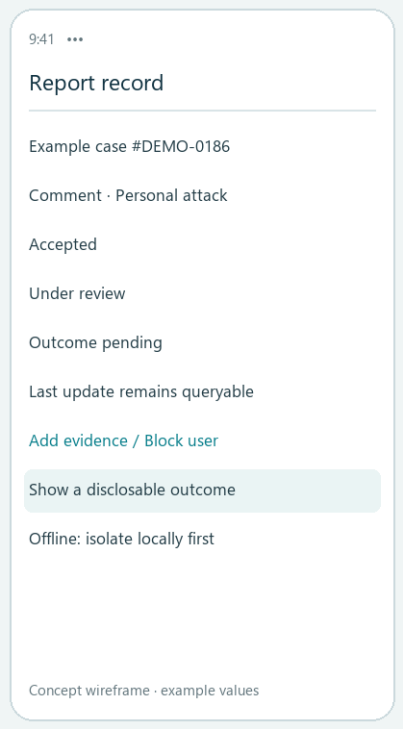
Privacy and failures

Keep unsuccessful submissions as drafts. Repeated submissions open the existing case with an option to add evidence. Disclose necessary outcome categories; the record center remains available when notifications fail.

Acceptance and measures

Check IDs, consistent states, evidence supplementation, queryable outcomes and offline isolation. Measure acceptance success/latency, handling time, outcome visibility and post-block contact failures.


9:41
Submit a report
Reported content: example comment
Choose a category
Abuse or personal attack
Harassment / minor safety
Threats, fraud or impersonation
Necessary context attached
Additional details (optional)
Submit report
Accepted after server confirms ID
Concept wireframe · example values


9:41
Report record
Example case #DEMO-0186
Comment · Personal attack
Accepted
Under review
Outcome pending
Last update remains queryable
Add evidence / Block user
Show a disclosable outcome
Offline: isolate locally first
Concept wireframe · example values

Validation plan and delivery evidence

Define reviewable next steps

Stage	Checks	Decision gate
Baseline	Current-release verification and 14-day measures	Remove resolved or unreproducible issues
Limited rollout	Release in stages with rollback switches	Evaluate task experience, performance, revenue and safety
Evaluation	Success rates, failures, handling times and guardrails	Set targets from baseline; pause expansion on serious failures

Artifacts

Research synthesis; needs analysis and priority matrix; QQ Music/Spotify comparison; full Chinese PRD; bilingual case studies and six concept wireframes with task flows and business rules.

Traceability

Scenario → flow → prototype → event → acceptance criterion. Section 16 of the full PRD contains the mapping; this case explains the three task chains separately.

Implementation dependencies

Content metadata and playlist services, client/ad SDK behavior, membership entitlements, moderation-state APIs, customer operations and analytics. Each dependency has a failure-handling rule.

Project context

An independent product-research project studying the NetEase Cloud Music mobile app. Deliverables include user research, prioritization, competitive analysis, product requirements and concept wireframes.

Project repository

https://github.com/Ginga2003/netease-cloud-music-product-case

AI music | Source transparency and informed choice

Help listeners understand available production information before listening, saving or purchasing, and provide controls, correction requests and traceable outcomes.

Evidence

Public user feedback, reporting and platform materials inform the problem; client behavior, detector performance and review capacity require validation.

Verification

Record production roles and evidence. Use basic checks, asynchronous screening and targeted rechecks, with human review for unresolved conflicts, appeals and audits.

Source and preference rules

Separate verified generation, publisher declarations, active suspicions and unknowns. A matching generated component excludes the track; a human contribution cannot override other generated components.

Purchases and corrections

Apply explicit source and license admission rules, disclose price and rights, preserve order snapshots and link material corrections to affected purchases.

Deliverables

A focused Chinese PRD, listener wireframes, publisher operations, phased acceptance criteria and capacity planning. Validate outcomes through task tests and implementation review.

https://github.com/Ginga2003/netease-cloud-music-product-case/blob/main/docs/en/ai-music-requirements.md